



Primary Playbook



Purpose

This document sets out the strategies and support used across the Primary Schools in Nova Education Trust to create transformational schools.

It shows where we are consistent, so that alignment across our primary schools adds genuine value. It ensures all school leaders, staff and our central team understand how we are making our vision of transformational schools a reality in our early years and primary settings.

Many elements are consistent with practice in our secondary schools and sixth form provision, but the focus of this document is alignment across our primary schools.

Our Strategic Priorities

At the heart of the Nova mission are three strategic priorities:

- 1 Ambition and Inclusion**
Removing barriers, unleashing potential and improving lives
- 2 Advocacy and Innovation**
Nurturing creativity, discovery and experiment
- 3 Culture**
Culture and solutions

These enable us to ensure that all schools in Nova Education Trust are aligned on their goals. In primary, these broad goals are shared across our schools and drive our school improvement framework.

The **Five Year Strategic Plan** sets out these goals in more detail.

School Self Evaluation and Improvement Planning

Each school is responsible for collating and using all information available about the school's context, performance against national benchmarks and qualitative feedback from internal and external quality assurance, to evaluate the school accurately and robustly against the criteria statements set out in the Ofsted Toolkit. Each school should assess against each statement criteria, clarifying the process used meet the statement criteria and the evidence used to justify their evaluation of met or not (where possible, this should be quantifiable and measurable against national benchmarks and statistical neighbours). The information behind each individual assessment is used to make a judgement on the overall category the school is a secure fit within. In safeguarding, this will be Met or Not Met. For the other areas, this will be Urgent Improvement, Needs Attention, Expected, Strong or Exceptional.

Schools will hold this information and provide a summary self-evaluation, through the Nova Self-Evaluation Tool, which provides the platform to do this and automates a summary matrix, summary narrative and improvement priorities for the school. For schools that are approaching or in the Ofsted window, the school will also produce a Self-Evaluation Summary to communicate the school's context, current self-evaluation grades and the rationale behind these decisions. A centralised AI mega Prompt will be used to support schools in producing this in a way that captures

the correct tone and content for the intended audience of Ofsted.

Based on their self-evaluation schools will generate 2-4 school improvement priorities, which are communicated through the school improvement plan. This document sets out what the priorities are, the success criteria associated with them (which act as key performance indicators), and the rationale for selecting these priorities. Schools will review progress against these priorities regularly and provide a half-termly update through TSIM meetings to the Primary Director of School Improvement.

The school will identify which elements require a time-based action plan to drive improvement; most areas will need one. These should be written using the GOST model of Goal, Objective, Strategy and Tactics to set the actions. The action plan captures the specific tactics and the micro-steps within them that are being used to bring the strategy to life, achieve the objective and accomplish the goal. Progress against targets set out in the action plans is assessed half-termly by the Head Teacher. This information is used alongside fresh information about the school's context, performance against national benchmarks and qualitative feedback from internal and external quality assurance, to update the school self-evaluation. This may lead to school priorities being adjusted or changed.

Internal Governance and Quality Assurance

To ensure there is consistency in self-evaluation judgements we have a regular and developmental quality assurance schedule. This means each Primary school will have two externally (Trust staff) supported QA visits on the following areas: Behaviour, Teaching Strategies (linked to the ILP Strands) and Curriculum & Achievement. The school will produce a summary report (based on their internal report) on these areas in the term that they are not supported externally.

Alongside this each term a school will undertake focused quality assurance visit to look at the quality of provision for all SEND children and another focused quality assurance visit to look at Safeguarding culture and compliance. Each visit for Safeguarding will be led by the Trust Safeguarding Lead and one of the visits for SEND will be led by the Trust Primary SEND Lead. These visits will be supported by the DOSI Primary where possible and utilise expertise from other Trust schools to work in partnership. Typically, a focused QA visit will last half a day, the dates are provisionally set for the whole school year, but these are flexed to meet the needs of the school and availability of those leading or supporting the QA.

The timeline for a QA visit is consistent and follows the pattern below:

- Two weeks before QA Visit (HT and QA Lead agree scope and focus). Informed by School Self Evaluation.
- One week before all QA documentation sent to QA team.
- QA Visit (Typically 4 hours).
- Within 48 hours report shared with HT.
- Within a week of the QA visit feedback provided to staff.
- No more than 2 weeks following the QA, Action Plans and SEF updated as appropriate.

The visual representation opposite shows the schedule across the primary schools in the trust. In addition to this, a focused QA of governance is undertaken in the autumn term for all primary schools. This is led by the governance lead for Nova Education Trust. There will also be external support for schools within six months of entering the Ofsted window, or those already within it. This support and challenge will come from a phase specific practicing Ofsted inspector external to Nova Education Trust.

	 Robert Miles Infant School	 FIREBECK ACADEMY Primary School and Nursery Provision	 FOREST TOWN PRIMARY SCHOOL Work Hard • Be Kind	 VICTORIA Primary School	 BIRKLANDS PRIMARY SCHOOL	 Westdale Junior School
Autumn 1	Safeguarding	SEND	SEND	SEND	Safeguarding	Safeguarding
	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour (inc. PD)	T&L (ILP)	T&L (ILP)	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement
Autumn 2	SEND	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	SEND	SEND
	T&L (ILP)	Curriculum and Achievement	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour (inc. PD)	T&L (ILP)	Behaviour (inc. PD)
Spring 1	SEND	SEND	SEND	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	Safeguarding
	Behaviour (inc. PD)	T&L (ILP)	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement	Curriculum and Achievement	T&L (ILP)
Spring 2	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	SEND	SEND	SEND
	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour	T&L (ILP)	T&L (ILP)	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement
Summer 1	SEND	SEND	SEND	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	Safeguarding
	T&L (ILP)	T&L (ILP)	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour (inc. PD)
Summer 2	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	Safeguarding	SEND	SEND	SEND
	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement	Behaviour (inc. PD)	Curriculum and Achievement	T&L (ILP)	T&L (ILP)

Alongside these quality assurance visits are Transformational School Improvement Meetings (TSIMs) which happen half termly. In these meetings the Director of School Improvement (DOSI) meets with the Head Teacher and occasionally other leaders. They typically last two hours and have the following focusses:

- Shared discussion and look at evidence base relating to School SEF.
- Discussion on progress against identified priorities in the SIF.
- Identification of any barriers to progress and risks to the school that can be removed or lessened by support from other schools and Nova Trust central capacity and resources.

The TSIM meetings will also involve surface level walk to engage with children, staff and the school community as well as providing a surface level judgement on whether the school environment and culture is contributing positively to learning. Each TSIM visit will have a record of visit which contains highlighted actions and is shared with the Head Teacher within 48 hours of the visit.

Each half term there will be a catch-up meeting between the Head Teacher and the DOSI. This meeting

starts with discussions on any operational issues; it then progresses into Head Teacher coaching. This meeting is not formally recorded, but any subsequent actions are agreed and emailed as a record and reminder. Whilst these meetings are half termly, emerging issues and ongoing coaching is provided as needed via the phone, on Teams or in person if requested by the HT.

The final layer of quality assurance and internal governance is the CEO visits which are undertaken by Ash Rahman each term. Much like the surface level walk undertaken by the DOSI in the TSIM this provides the CEO to quality assure for themselves the school environment and culture as they also engage with the school community to gather staff and pupil voice.

The findings from all the quality assurance activities described are used to inform the school SEF which is written against the Ofsted framework categories and uses the information in the Ofsted toolkit. The SEF alongside the Primary Dashboard which contains all key benchmark figures for each school is then used by the DOSI Primary to provide reports to the Exec team through ESB and TSB and then to Trustees through papers to the Education Board. There is opportunity for Trustees and Governors to request to join any of the Primary QA activities.

Primary Support Team

Alongside the Director of School Improvement for Primary, there is also a team of staff to support schools in delivering transformational education.

The central operations team — led by Michael Davies (Chief Finance and Operations Officer) and supported by the Directors of IT, Operations and People — support schools with all non-education related matters. Staff from the Finance, People, IT and Data Services, Health, Safety and Compliance, Governance and Premises teams routinely work with schools to ensure they have the platform to deliver a transformational experience for the school's staff, children and the communities in a safe and sustainable way.

The trust has a safeguarding lead who works cross-phase to support schools and ensure safeguarding culture and systems are robust. There is also support from the trust attendance lead and, where appropriate, the Director of School Improvement for Inclusion.

There are centralised primary-specific roles that provide more intense and regular support for the Nova primaries.

Primary Inclusion Lead

Rachel Mousley (3.5 days a week)

Rachel provides strategic leadership and oversight of Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND) provision across schools, ensuring that all pupils with SEND have equitable access to high-quality education and the opportunity to achieve and thrive. The role supports schools through a combination of coaching, joint monitoring, quality assurance and targeted professional development. This includes strengthening inclusive practice, ensuring statutory compliance, and building SENCo capacity at both strategic and operational levels. Support is bespoke and responsive to individual school needs, while maintaining a consistent and robust approach to SEND across the wider provision.

Each primary school will receive:

- Minimum of two planned visits per half term including initial strategic planning meeting with SLT.

- Quality Assurance with written feedback and action planning
- Statutory SEND compliance checks (including EHCP processes and SEND registers)
- Support and preparation for OFSTED inspections and onsite during inspections.
- Annual Medical Needs and First Aid audit
- Induction and mentoring for SENCOs new to role
- Termly SEND newsletters with updates, guidance and best practice
- SENCO networks and collaboration opportunities
- Access to a shared SEND Handbook and SEND Resource Bank
- Coaching to support effective provision mapping and impact evaluation
- Guidance on parental engagement and multi-agency working

ILP, Curriculum and Achievement Lead Dave Edwards (2.5 days a week)

Dave is responsible for driving implementation in school of the aligned approaches to teaching and learning across Nova Primaries. This role works on bringing the Primary strategy to life through the use of the ILP framework, Playbooks and common achievement tracking systems to ensure all children

have a transformational Primary school experience. This includes:

- Working with the Director of School Improvement for Primary and external partners to shape strategy.
- Working with external partners: Sync, Magma Maths, Showbie, Olex and Microsoft to ensure we are utilizing product effectively.
- Working with the Lead Innovator and Innovators to ensure there is alignment and consistency in the use of digital technology and tools.
- Analysing a range of data sources and undertaking QA to accurately report on usage in schools and identify barriers.
- Developing Curriculum playbooks in foundation subjects and contributing to revisions of core subject playbooks.
- Providing CPD for staff across the Primaries.
- Accessing external CPD and working with other trusts to disseminate information to Nova Primaries.
- Collating and producing the Monthly Nova Primaries Magazine 'Supercharged'.
- Leading in the development of Quest Progress, Olex AI, Reading Progress, Magma Maths and Showbie Assessments to support assessment.
- Supporting the development of AI use to support workflow across Nova Trust.

ILP Innovators

A member of staff in each school is identified as the school's Innovator; this means they are responsible for driving the use of digital technology tools to amplify teaching and learning through the Innovative Learning Partnerships framework which is shown below.

They meet half termly with Innovators from other Nova primaries and work with national partners as well as staff from other trusts. They have access to CPD and tools in advance of other staff to ensure that when delivered to staff it can have the most significant impact it possible.

Early Years Lead Kelly Ryan (1 day a week)

Kelly supports Head Teachers, Early Years leaders and Early Years staff across the Trust to ensure that they are aware of the latest developments in EYFS guidance and best practice. This includes:

- Providing and signposting to training.
- Annual audit of EYFS provision and environments.
- Coaching of EYFS Leaders.
- EYFS curriculum developments.
- Supporting QA in schools.
- Attending and accessing DFE and LA briefings to provide guidance of school.



Curriculum in Nova Primaries

In our Nova Primaries we have aligned curriculum principles that are shaped through our Playbooks, subject Specific Playbooks exist for Reading, Writing, Maths, History and Geography with Playbooks for Science, Design, Art, RE and Computing to follow later in 2026-27. These playbooks share the key Disciplinary and Substantive skills, knowledge and concepts that should be developed during a child's time at a Nova Primary school.

Each school contextualises this and therefore contexts the learning is delivered through in each school may vary, however the expectations about what it looks like to have got better within a subject is the same across the trust, this enables moderation, shared CPD and support.

Much of this work has been influenced by Jonathon Lear and will begin to be shaped by Hywel Roberts and his Botherdness approach. This will enable us to support schools in having a framework to create contexts that develop the children's emotional investment in what they are studying them and help them to think about the 'must' element of the curriculum through philosophical concepts linked to each school's individual values and contexts.

We believe the curriculum is not something to cover and evidence and should be seen as a learning journey, therefore the way children express their learning, through this journey, will be varied and not always through outcomes in a book.

To capture this, outcomes can be captured digitally and uploaded to Showbie so the curriculum journey is clear, misconceptions can be identified and feedback provided in a variety of ways.

Specifically in Maths there is no need for Mathematical understanding to be captured in books, instead the majority of this will be completed in Magma Maths and where work is undertaken in a different way this will be uploaded to Showbie.

Therapeutic Learning Environments

All Nova Primaries should be intentional about the choices they make to ensure that all communal spaces, break out spaces and classrooms follow the principles and approaches communicated through the Therapeutic Learning Environments Playbook.

By doing so, all children have access to environments that support their wellbeing and enable them to thrive. Schools take responsibility for ensuring that communal areas are developed to reflect the Playbook guidance and that classrooms awaiting investment to convert them to a Therapeutic classroom are making the changes they can for little or no cost before the classroom is transformed as per the scheduled plan over the next two year to ensure all classrooms benefit from a Therapeutic design, furniture and fittings.



Trust-Wide Enrichment

The personal development offer across Nova primaries will continue to centre on a high-quality enrichment entitlement.

Schools should offer a broad enrichment offer that can be accessed by all children aligned with our ambition to secure 11 Experiences by 11 for every child. This enrichment for all may happen during or outside the school day and any barriers for individual children should be removed by the school through offer design, this includes cost.

Beyond this there will be some enrichment opportunities that children and families can choose to access and others that will be offered specifically to target groups and individuals. Personal Development Leads from each primary school will work collaboratively, both within their own settings and on behalf of one another, to ensure that bespoke enrichment opportunities meet the needs all pupils withing the school community.

Under the guidance of Anna Froggatt, Nova Primary PD Leads will be supported to deliver this vision effectively, including the coordination of termly trust-wide whole-school events namely, Remembrance and the Food Bank in the Autumn term; World Book Day in the Spring term; and Culture Day and Sports Day in the Summer term. In the coming year, the Personal Development strategy will also focus on strengthening the curriculum offer, ensuring that each school's provision meaningfully enhances the personal development of every child.

The children enrichment experiences will be tracked through Tracker + so analysis of groups and individuals can take place as well as reflections on impact of enrichment experiences on other measures such as behaviour, academic achievement and attendance.

Achievement in Nova Primaries

The guiding questions in Nova Primaries:

- Which children are not on track? Either below age-related expectations or below their individual target.
- What is the specific gap or barrier? The precise piece of learning missing, or the barrier preventing progress.
- What are we doing about it? The targeted action being taken in teaching, practice or intervention.

To ensure that all children can achieve assessment must be robust and routine. In Nova Primaries the teacher and any support staff should be clear on precise learning goal for the class or for individuals if this differs, they must define what success in the lesson looks like. Teachers should ask themselves, 'what will children know, understand or be able to better by the end of the lesson. Schools are expected to:

- Use the Nova Playbooks as the source of learning goals for reading, writing and maths.
- Use the school's chosen phonics scheme (Read Write Inc or Little Wandle) as the source for phonics goals.
- Set goals for pupils on alternative curriculum pathways that reflect their starting point and intended outcomes, not age-related expectations.

Each school is expected to ensure children have the opportunity to be successful by ensuring:

- Ready pupils move straight into independent practice focused on accuracy, fluency and independence.
- Secure pupils move into extension - depth, challenge or application in a different context.
- Pupils with a barrier are signposted to scaffolds and supported by the teacher during independent practice. The class does not wait.

Each school is expected to use the following tools as part of daily practice:

- Showbie for in-lesson assessment of all pupils. Teachers should be using heat maps and AI insights to identify understanding and misconceptions in real time.
- Magma Maths for low-stakes assessment combined with personalised follow-up questions. Follow-ups should be used in class, at home or during transition times.
- TT Rockstars for multiplication fluency in preparation for the Multiplication Check. Practice must be directed by heat maps, not set as routine homework.

Subject-Specific Assessment

Each school is expected to have the following in place:

- Phonics — frequent assessment tied to the teaching sequence, with outcomes recorded in Phonic scheme specific trackers if already utilised with Tracker+ used to record practise screening scores, summative Phonics grade (PITA) and reading book bands.
- Reading — Microsoft Reading Progress used to assess fluency, accuracy and prosody, with key information recorded in Tracker+.
- Writing (transcription) — Kaligo used alongside teacher observation in books to identify handwriting and transcription issues.
- KS1 Maths — termly benchmarking through Showbie or Magma Maths, recorded in Tracker+.

Summative KS2 Assessment

All KS2 pupils complete termly Quest Progress assessments in arithmetic, mathematical reasoning, reading, and spelling, grammar and vocabulary. Schools are expected to:

- Add Standardised Age Scores to Tracker+.
- Use the data to track progress in months, identify gaps and project likely SATs outcomes.
- Discuss the outcomes in pupil progress meetings and use them to plan teaching and intervention.

Point in Time Assessment (PITA)

Every pupil must have a current PITA score and a target PITA score for the end of the year, on a 1–6 scale, recorded in Tracker+. The subjects each year group should enter a PITA score for is shown below as well as the 6 point grading system used.

ON TRACK ASSESSMENT IN PRIMARY

1 Alternative Pathway



Children who will not be entered into a statutory assessment.

2 Working Significantly Below



Children who need significant curriculum content adaptations and are accessing learning outside of their Key Stage or Phase of Key Stage 2.

3 Not on Track



Children who have some gaps in foundational knowledge and skills that means they are unlikely to meet the standard in the next statutory assessment. This should be based on what has been taught and is expected for their year group.

4 On Track



Children who may still have some weaknesses or gaps, but overall are on track to meet the standard in the next statutory assessment. This should be based on what has been taught and is expected for their year group.

5 On Track Plus



Children who do not have gaps and are on track to exceed the standard in the next statutory assessment. This should be based on what has been taught and is expected for their year group.

6 Working Beyond



Children who need significant curriculum content adaptations and are routinely accessing learning outside of their Key Stage or Phase of Key Stage 2.

Year Group	GLD	Phonics Screening	Multiplication Tables Check	Reading	Writing	Maths
FS1						
FS2						
Y1						
Y2						
Y3						
Y4						
Y5						
Y6						

- All children in this year group will have an assessment inputted.
- Some children in this year group will have an assessment inputted.
- No children in this year group will have an assessment inputted.

Where a pupil is below PITA 4 or below their target, the class teacher must add a short note, using information from the applicable data sources discussed earlier, in Tracker+ explaining:

- What the pupil can currently do
- Where the key gaps are
- What needs to happen next

These notes are the basis of pupil progress meetings. HTs should expect them to be in place for every off-track child before each meeting.

What schools must avoid:

- Assessment only at the end of a unit
- Recording data without action
- Whole-class reteaching based on assumptions
- Repeating practice without targeting gaps
- Overcomplicating systems

Data Collection in 26-27

Achievement information will be captured through Tracker+, consistently across all trust schools. Reading, Writing and Maths are recorded using the 6-category PITA system, tracking progress towards the next statutory assessment point. There will be specific windows when Quest Progress and internal KS1 benchmarking tests can be administered, there will be a deadline for when summative assessment grades must be inputted into Tracker+ each term, this will routinely be the Friday of the penultimate week of term.

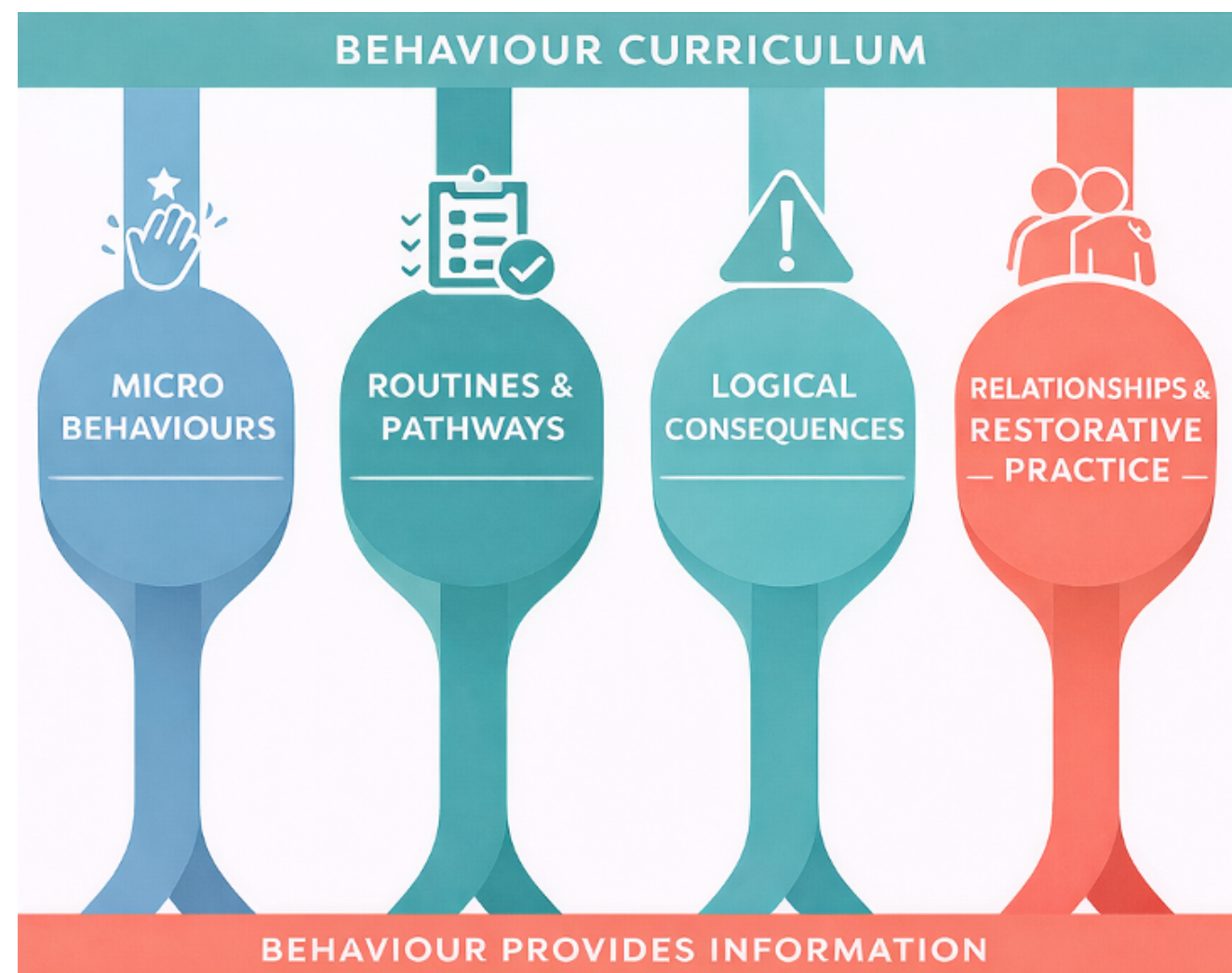
Behaviour

To further develop behaviour of adults and children in Nova Primaries we have created a Primary specific Behaviour Playbook based on the approaches taken in the overall Nova Behaviour Policy.

The Playbook is built around the model shown below with in depth guidance, CPD and resources for each strand provided. Lucy Potts supports schools in ensuring that they implement the Behaviour Playbook and Curriculum consistently, this is done through on site support, leading QA, in person and online training.

There is also a centrally produced and collated set of CPD materials and resources to use with children and families that has been created by Lucy in partnership with schools. We track a summative assessment of children's behaviour through Tracker+ with a numerical value relating to the descriptors shown below.

The overall behaviour grade for a child is based on the aggregation of the grade for each individual strand, so a child cannot be meeting expectations overall if they are not in one of the sub categories.



BEHAVIOUR TRACKING AT NOVA

Behaviour Score	1 Alternative Pathway	2 Causing Significant Concern	3 Less than Expected	4 Meeting Expectations	5 Exceeding Expectations	6 Significantly Beyond Expectations
Behaviour Descriptor	 Criteria not appropriate for child.	 (Rarely follows the school rules)	 (Regularly does not follow the school rules the majority of the time)	 (Following the school rules the majority of the time)	 (Following the school rules all of the time)	
Engagement in Learning	Child will never meet expectations due to significant SEND barrier.	Is not fulfilling any of the meeting expectations criteria.	Is not fulfilling some of the meeting expectations criteria.	- Joins in with learning. - Responds positively to challenges. - Responds to feedback positively. - If distracted can get back on task quickly.	- Never distracted from learning. - Challenges themselves. - Seeks feedback and is relentless in trying to improve.	- Asks questions that deepen the thinking of the whole class. - Extends learning independently, making links across subjects. - Raises the standard of learning in those around them.
Relationships with School Staff	Child will never meet expectations due to significant SEND barrier.	Is not fulfilling any of the meeting expectations criteria.	Is not fulfilling some of the meeting expectations criteria.	- Follows instructions quickly. - Displays good manners consistently. - Is respectful to all adults.	- Always displays impeccable manners. - Is trusted by adults to act as a role model to others. - Engages with all adults with maturity and integrity.	- Represents the school confidently to visitors and wider trust staff. - Acts on feedback without prompting and needs no supervision.
Relationships with Other Children	Child will never meet expectations due to significant SEND barrier.	Is not fulfilling any of the meeting expectations criteria.	Is not fulfilling some of the meeting expectations criteria.	- Does not intentionally distract other children. - Treats other children kindly. - Is able to resolve conflict and friendship issues with regular success. - Can work well as part of a team.	- Is a role model for other children during lessons. - Supports other children in solving friendship and conflict issues. - Works well in a team and if needed can lead a team well.	- Notifies peers who are struggling and responds without being asked. - Resolves conflict fairly, often before adults need to step in. - Respected as a leader across year groups, not just their own circle.



Trust Alignment through shared CPD and Networks

As the primary schools in Nova share many of the same goals we have worked to create aligned strategies to make these a reality.

To do this, we have gained the support of transformational trainers, leaders and organisations beyond Nova. This enables us to ensure we are accessing the best CPD and developing common approaches rooted in the latest research and strongest existing practice.

Below is the a summary of the primary-specific groups we have established and their purpose. The details of frequency and group leads are then exemplified in a table which also contains cross phase groups.

To develop system leadership, staff from across Nova primaries take responsibility for co-ordinating a group.

Staff from Nova Primaries will also attend Cross Phase Networks for SEND, Safeguarding, Attendance and Personal Development. Each School/Business Manager will also attend the Trust Business and Operations Manager Network.



Guerrilla Curriculum Group

Since 2025 we have partnered with Jonathon Lear the founder of Guerrilla Education (<https://guerrillaeducation.co.uk/>) to help us deliver our Unique Schools Proposition (USP) through our curriculum design. Like us Jonathon is driven by the belief that committed individuals can and do make a difference. Rather than insist on one curriculum across all of our schools we want to celebrate the diverse nature of our schools through curriculums that meet the needs of the community. However, we do want shared principles that link to our USP. The work Jonathon undertakes with our Curriculum leads in group sessions and via 1:1 support will enable all of our schools to have transformational curriculums. The work undertaken by this group directly informs our Curriculum focused QA visits.

Botherdness

In the summer of 2026 we began a partnership with Hywel Roberts to implement his Botherdness approach into the Innovative Learning Partnership and curriculum. Botherdness places stories at the heart of the curriculum to create people in a place with the children taking on a role in understanding and solving the problem. This approach provides children with a call to action and provides a context for learning that ensures the disciplinary skills/knowledge and substantive concepts/knowledge children are developing in a subject is dropped to the universals so it feels real, can be accessed by all and supports children's understanding of philosophical concepts.

Each school has access to the Botherdness CPD platform, Nova specific Botherdness Webinars and AI planning tools. In each school a Botherdness lead will attend a 5 day training programme led by Hywel which involves modelled lessons, collaborating with other schools and production of resources.

Nova's Strategic Leadership of Reading, Writing and Maths

Leaders of Reading, Writing and Maths meet separately to work collaboratively to bring the Nova playbooks for these subjects to life in their schools. Each subject has an overall Strategic Leadership facilitator who leads these meetings and sets tasks for Leaders to undertake in their individual schools. They collate common issues identified across the schools and ensure consistency in how the playbooks are being interpreted in an individual school. These meetings take place online after school

twice each half term for the first 6 months of the year, the frequency of the meetings then reduces as time is focussed on embedding in schools.



Maths Hubs

We work closely with the East Midlands East Maths Hub (<https://ememathshub.org/>) to ensure all our schools are accessing support and CPD. We have ensured that all schools have selected complimentary CPD courses so we are aligned on the areas that we are working on and we have identified Maths leaders within our schools who will progress to become Primary Maths Specialists in Nova and beyond.



English Hubs

Early Reading and Phonics is at the heart of Primary Teaching and Learning, we recognise that without fundamental reading skills children are unable to access our broad curriculums and become disengaged with school. We work with the English Hubs (<https://www.flyinghighpartnership.co.uk/futures/flying-high-english-hub/>) on the narrow focus of Early Reading and Phonics. Each school works with the Hub to complete an annual audit and this then informs action planning which is

then supported by the English Hub with frequency of visits dependent on the outcome of the audits. The English Hub regularly provides additional training opportunities and will be broadening its offer of support beyond Early Reading and Phonics, schools should be proactive in utilising these opportunities and support when available.

Head Teacher Development

Our Head Teachers work closely together both through formal activities such as Quality Assurance and informally through phone support and network meetings. We ensure all our Head Teachers have visited at least 2 other Primary schools in the Trust each year. Each year our Head Teachers will visit an exemplary setting outside of Nova as a group. Each half term there will be an online meeting for Primary Head Teachers where we can share key updates and explore emerging themes across the Trust. Through the year there will be 2 Face to Face Head Teacher Training morning for Primary Head Teachers and 2 Face to Face Joint Head Teacher Training Days Primary and Secondary. It is expected that each Head Teacher will support at least one QA in another school over the year and there will be opportunity to support QA in other trusts as part of their growth and development.

Nova internal CPD and Accreditation Pathway

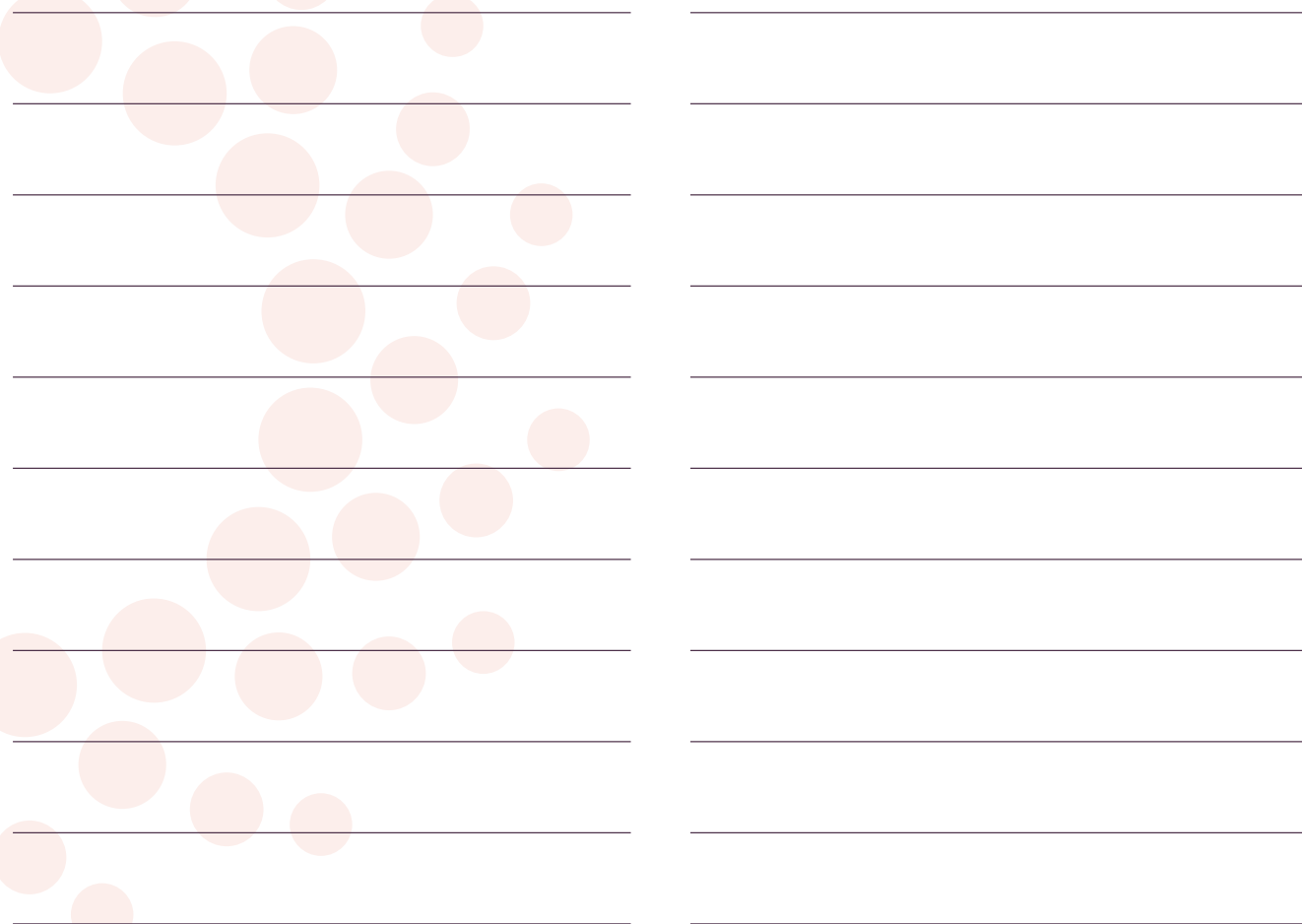
We have designed a series of webinars that staff can access to support them understanding the ILP Framework. All staff complete the Accessibility and Adaptation Webinars and reflection activities resulting

in being accredited as having engaged in this CPD. There is then a series of webinars focussed on the 4 ILP Strands of Direct Instruction, Independent Practice, Assessment and Feedback. After completing the webinars, tasks and reflections staff can then request to be assessed and if successful be accredited as completing the Nova CPD for the relevant stand of the ILP Framework. Once a member of staff has become accredited in all the strands they can work towards becoming a Nova Advanced Skills Teacher which is a rigorous process, this accreditation comes with addition remuneration and responsibility for modelling teaching to others in Nova and externally as well as taking on the coaching of others. Accreditation is reassessed every 2 years.

Teaching Assistant CPD

We recognise and value the wide range of skills that our Support Staff have and want to share this across our Trust. A series of webinars and CPD will be led by support staff in 2026-27 showcasing specialist knowledge and expertise they have. We will also work with Matt Parker from Maximising the Impact of Teaching Assistant to compliment this work and further develop our support staff. Teaching Assistants can also work towards accreditation in the ILP framework should they feel this fits with their role and is appropriate.

Notes

The background of the entire page is decorated with a pattern of horizontal lines and pink circles. The left half of the page features a light pink background with horizontal lines and a cluster of pink circles of various sizes. The right half of the page has a light blue background with horizontal lines.



Robert Miles
Infant School



Westdale
Junior School



VICTORIA
Primary School



FOREST TOWN PRIMARY SCHOOL
Work Hard • Be Kind



BIRKLANDS
PRIMARY SCHOOL

Nova Education Trust

C09–C11, The Sir Colin Campbell Building, University of Nottingham Innovation Park
Triumph Road, Nottingham NG7 2TU

0115 807 7777 contact@novaeducationtrust.net www.novaeducationtrust.net

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